

Dual-screen laptop

gScreen, an Alaska-based notebook designer and manufacturer, is going to launch the world's first dual-screen laptop by the year-end. The gScreen Spacebook will have two 39cm screens that slide away to fill the space of a single screen when the laptop is stored



World's first dual-screen laptop—gScreen Spacebook

or transported.

The laptop is aimed at professional video editors, photographers and designers who need to flick between different applications to carry out their work. But anyone willing to shell out the expected \$3000 price tag should be aware that the double screen is likely to push the weight of the Spacebook significantly above standard laptops. Also, running two monitors will drain the computer's batteries faster.

Connect your home electronics wirelessly

Here's a way to beat entanglements. Philips has announced a wireless HDMI product that will let you connect home electronics products like a television and a Blu-Ray player without using any wire.

The product consists of two boxes. The image source—for example,

a set-top box or a Blu-ray player—is connected to a transmitter box and the TV or the projector is connected to a smaller receiver box. The Wireless HDMI Link makes sense only if the two products are not located next to each other, but in different parts of the living room. The dis-

tance between the transmitter and receiver can be up to 25 metres, but only if the two are located in the same room.

The wireless HDMI link will cost \$850.

Slimmer, lighter plasma TVs

Panasonic's NeoPDP technology is claimed to make plasma screens slimmer and lighter with improved picture contrast and colour accuracy. NeoPDP improves the efficiency of three different components of screen performance—materials and processes, gas discharge and cell design along with electronic circuit technologies. The 'gas discharge and cell design' element of NeoPDP introduces larger plasma cells that emit more light using less power. Using the same amount of power, NeoPDP screens are said to be 50 per cent brighter.



Philips wireless HDMI link for home electronics

Sony to launch 3D TVs by 2010-end

Consumers will soon be able to buy Sony Bravia television sets, Vaio laptops, Playstation3 gaming consoles and Blu-ray disk players that are compatible with 3D technology. Sony plans to put 3D televisions in homes by the end of 2010. It will be an important boost for the 3D industry, which until now has concentrated on enhancing the cinema screen experience.

Speech-to-text for cellphones

Texting while driving is distracting. And while no technology has been developed yet to prevent a phone user from touching the device while behind the wheel, speech recognition software may help to some extent.

There are a growing number of speech recognition programs for phones. Some, such as Google Voice Search and Tellme, are free and allow Web search by voice. Others involve one-time purchases or are subscription based, and offer more expansive features such as speech-based text messaging and e-mails.

Voice on the Go is a full-featured speech-recognition program that lets users receive, listen to and send e-mail and 15-second text messages by voice. Your Facebook status can also be updated that way, and you can even send tweets to Twitter using your voice. The program works on all cellphones. Using it requires first dialing a local number, then saying or entering a PIN to activate Voice on the Go.

Tellme, whose voice search programs work on a number of different phones, will have a speech-to-text message application as part of Windows Mobile 6.5 operating system for phones. You will be able to speak the name of a contact in your address book and place a call.

Bring smartphone abilities to your feature phone

Microsoft has announced the OneApp service that promises to bring